PAUSE BARBELL BENCH PRESS

PLEASE NOTE: The execution of this exercise will be the same as explained below, just adding a 1 second pause at the bottom position.

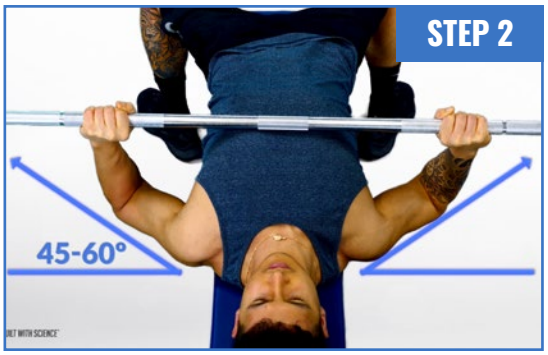
STEP 1 SETUP

Lie down on the bench and position yourself such that your eyes are directly below the racked bar. Use a medium grip on the bar that's slightly wider than shoulder-width apart. Pull your shoulder blades down away from your ears and pinch them together to create a small space between your lower back and the bench. Firmly plant your feet on the ground. Unrack the bar and bring it over the level of your shoulders

STEP 2

Control the weight down while dropping your elbows down at about a 45 to 60 degree angle from your torso. The bar should travel down and slightly forward and touch your chest at the level of your sternum.

After the bar touches your chest, push the bar up and back to the starting position with your arms fully locked out. The bar should travel up and slightly back as you do this. Think about pulling your arms together as if you were trying to touch your biceps together to move the weight up.



ADDITIONAL TIPS

Avoid bouncing the bar against your chest at the bottom position and use control to simply touch your chest. Whenever possible use a spotter, especially with heavier loads.